

Field Study 2025

Field Study 2025: Soil Erosion on the North Ridge

Across all three monitored plots, erosion rates accelerated sharply following the removal of hedgerow cover in early spring. Plot B lost an estimated 14 tonnes of topsoil per hectare over the season, roughly triple the ten-year average for comparable terrain.

The dominant mechanism was rill formation during high-intensity rainfall. Once a rill network established itself, subsequent moderate rainfall events caused disproportionate losses.

We conclude that hedgerow retention is the single most effective intervention available at this site, and that replanting should be prioritised on the steepest gradients before the next wet season.